Gastroenterology – Section Summary

UGIB • Varices • Oesophageal injury • Colitis • Biliary • Pancreatitis • Liver failure

Critical Care Board Review • Section 25 • MCQ-Oriented

1. Bleeding

- Ulcer bleed → **IV PPI 80 mg + 8 mg/h**; after therapy stable → floor
- Variceal → **PPI/octreotide + ceftriaxone**, banding; secondary prophylaxis **nadolol + repeat banding 2–4 wk**
- Mesenteric ischaemia suspicion → **CTA without oral contrast**

2. Oesophagus & Bowel

- Caustic ingestion → **early endoscopy** (< 24 h); perforation suspicion → imaging
- Feeding intolerance/distension → stop feeds, NG suction
- Post-antibiotic diarrhoea → **oral vancomycin**
- UC flare → **LMWH prophylaxis**; refractory/toxic → **colectomy**

3. Biliary & Pancreas

- Acalculous cholecystitis (ventilated) → **percutaneous cholecystostomy**
- Cholangitis/abscess → cipro + metronidazole
- Pancreatitis → **LR ~300 mL/h** initially (moderate)
- Symptomatic pseudocyst → **cystogastrostomy**

4. Liver

- Paracetamol ALF meeting criteria → **transfer to transplant centre**
- Ischaemic hepatitis (AST ~5000) → **Doppler US** (exclude vascular)
- HE precipitants: infection, bleeding, ↓ K, sedatives — **not hyperkalaemia**
- SBP → **cefotaxime + albumin 1.5 g/kg**

5. High-Yield MCQ Pearls

- [x] Varices: antibiotic + octreotide
- [x] SBP: albumin day 1 & 3

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